

Wardle Editorial Canon

Standards for Governed Editorial Artifacts

Part VII - Governance Record Standards

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1. Purpose

Governance Record Standards define how WEOS preserves the assessments, reviews, validations, decisions, publication actions, exceptions, and historical events through which clinical knowledge becomes institutionally trusted.

Governance records are not secondary administrative metadata.

They are first-class editorial artifacts.

A governed artifact cannot be understood only from its current content and current status. Editors must also be able to determine:

- what was evaluated;
- which artifact version was considered;
- what evidence and context were available;
- which concerns were identified;
- who exercised authority;
- which decision was made;
- why that decision was defensible;
- what changed as a result;
- which obligations remain;
- what learners were permitted to see.

The purpose of this Part is to ensure that every meaningful editorial conclusion remains explicit, attributable, version-specific, explainable, and historically recoverable.

2. Governance Record Philosophy

WEOS governs living clinical knowledge.

Living knowledge changes through repeated interpretation and decision.

If the system preserves only the latest artifact state, it loses the reasoning that created institutional trust.

Governance records therefore preserve the institutional memory of editorial work.

They allow WEOS to reconstruct:

- how candidate knowledge entered the system;
- how clinical and educational confidence developed;
- why an artifact progressed or failed to progress;
- how disagreements were resolved;
- which exceptions were granted;
- why publication occurred;
- why knowledge was later withdrawn, superseded, or retired.

Governance records should not exist merely to demonstrate that an action occurred.

They should preserve enough context to understand whether the action was appropriate.

3. Governance Artifact Family

The canonical Governance Artifact family includes:

- Editorial Assessment;
- Editorial Review;
- Editorial Decision;
- Validation Result;
- Readiness Assessment;
- Publication Assessment;
- Publication Decision;
- Controlled Application Record;
- Withdrawal Record;
- Supersession Record;
- Retirement Record;
- Governance Exception;
- Emergency Correction Record;
- Disagreement and Adjudication Record;
- Conflict-of-Interest Declaration;
- Governance History.

These artifacts serve related but distinct purposes.

Implementations must not collapse them into a single status field or generic activity log where doing so erases editorial meaning.

4. Foundational Distinctions

4.1 Assessment and Decision

An assessment interprets the quality, state, risk, or readiness of an artifact.

A decision changes or confirms its governed standing.

An assessment may conclude that a case is clinically coherent.

A decision may approve the identified case revision.

The assessment supports the decision but is not the decision itself.

4.2 Review and Decision

A review is the governed process through which one or more assessments are completed and a required editorial question is considered.

A decision is the explicit outcome of that review.

Closing a review without a decision should be distinguishable from completing a review with approval, rejection, revision request, deferral, or escalation.

4.3 Validation and Approval

Validation evaluates compliance with defined rules, schemas, completeness expectations, or structured quality requirements.

Approval establishes human editorial confidence in an identifiable artifact version.

A passed validation must not be represented as approval.

A failed validation may block approval where policy identifies the failure as material.

4.4 Readiness and Status

Readiness is a computed or reasoned interpretation of whether an artifact may proceed to a defined next operation.

Status records the current governed or operational state.

Readiness must identify the operation being assessed, such as generation, review, application, playability, publication, maintenance, or retirement.

4.5 Approval and Publication

Approval indicates that an artifact version has satisfied its required editorial review.

Publication indicates that an approved artifact version has been authorised for learner-facing or institutional use.

Every publication must be supported by an explicit Publication Decision.

4.6 Audit Event and Governance Record

An audit event records that an action occurred.

A governance record preserves the editorial meaning, authority, rationale, context, and effect of that action.

A button click may produce an audit event.

The decision created through that action is a Governance Record.

4.7 Correction and Historical Revision

Correcting an inaccurate governance record should not silently replace the historical record.

The correction should preserve:

- the original record;
 - the identified error;
 - the correcting authority;
 - the corrected representation;
 - the reason for correction.
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5. Universal Governance Record Standard

Every material governance record should preserve a common canonical structure.

5.1 Stable Identity

Every Governance Record must possess a stable identity independent of its display location, workflow screen, or storage implementation.

5.2 Record Type

The record type must identify the editorial meaning of the record.

Examples include Clinical Assessment, Case Review, Request Revision Decision, Publication Decision, or Emergency Withdrawal.

5.3 Artifact Context

Every artifact-scoped record must identify:

- artifact type;
- artifact identity;
- diagnosis context where applicable;
- artifact version or revision;
- relevant source and target roles where more than one artifact is involved.

5.4 Governance Question

The record should identify the question being answered.

Examples include:

- Is this case clinically correct?
- Does this Teaching Relationship possess sufficient discriminatory value?
- May this Diagnosis Education version be published?
- Does this AI Draft remain applicable to the current target revision?
- Should this published artifact be withdrawn?

5.5 Actor and Authority

The record must preserve:

- responsible person or governed system actor;
- editorial role;
- authority exercised;
- institutional or specialty scope where relevant;
- delegation or acting authority where applicable.

Technical identity alone is insufficient.

5.6 Time

The record should preserve:

- creation time;
- decision time where different;
- effective time where relevant;
- closure time;
- expiry or review time where applicable.

5.7 Source Context

The record should preserve the information upon which the conclusion depended.

This may include:

- artifact version;
- review packet;
- previous findings;
- evidence sources;
- applicable policies;
- learning goals;
- teaching rules;
- reasoning paths;
- validation results;
- related governance decisions.

5.8 Findings

Findings should state what the reviewer, validator, or authority observed.

Findings should distinguish:

- confirmed issue;
- possible concern;
- informational observation;
- unresolved uncertainty;
- publication blocker;
- non-blocking warning.

5.9 Rationale

Every material conclusion must preserve rationale proportionate to its consequence.

Rationale should explain why the conclusion follows from the findings, policies, evidence, and artifact purpose.

5.10 Outcome

The record should identify the governed outcome.

Examples include:

- passed;
- failed;
- approved;
- rejected;
- revision required;
- evidence required;
- deferred;
- escalated;
- published;
- withdrawn;
- superseded;
- exception granted.

5.11 Effect

The record should identify what the outcome changed or permitted.

Possible effects include:

- lifecycle transition;
- blocker creation or resolution;
- publication eligibility;
- artifact application;
- operational activation;
- withdrawal from learner exposure;
- maintenance obligation;
- reassignment;
- escalation.

5.12 Remaining Obligations

Where work remains, the record should identify:

- required action;
- responsible role;
- affected artifact;
- expected next state;
- deadline or review trigger where relevant.

5.13 Linkage

Governance Records should be linkable to:

- preceding records;
- resulting records;
- superseded decisions;
- related artifacts;
- resulting revisions;
- publication events;
- maintenance events.

6. Record Scope and Materiality

Not every interaction requires a full Governance Record.

The system should distinguish material governance actions from routine operational activity.

A material action is one that affects:

- clinical meaning;
- educational intent;
- institutional confidence;
- artifact lifecycle;
- evidence sufficiency;
- publication eligibility;
- learner exposure;
- governance authority;
- historical interpretation.

Examples of material actions include:

- approving a case revision;
- rejecting a Teaching Rule;
- requesting evidence for a management claim;
- accepting and applying an AI Draft;
- publishing Diagnosis Education;
- withdrawing a case;
- granting a governance exception;
- adjudicating reviewer disagreement.

Examples of ordinary operational events may include:

- opening a review packet;
- filtering a queue;
- viewing an artifact;
- changing a non-governed display preference.

Operational events may remain auditable without being represented as editorial decisions.

7. Version-Specific Governance

Every approval, rejection, publication, validation, and material assessment must apply to an identifiable artifact version.

Governance must not apply ambiguously to mutable content.

Where an artifact changes materially after review:

- the earlier governance record remains valid for the earlier version;
- the new version does not inherit approval automatically;
- affected assessments should be repeated or explicitly carried forward;
- the system should identify which prior conclusions remain applicable;
- renewed approval should be required where policy determines the change is material.

A governance interface should never present an earlier approval as though it applies to unreviewed current content.

8. Editorial Assessment

8.1 Purpose

An Editorial Assessment is a structured interpretation of one or more dimensions of an artifact, diagnosis, curriculum area, or governance question.

Assessments support decision-making without independently changing the artifact state.

8.2 Assessment Families

Canonical assessment families include:

- Clinical Assessment;
- Educational Assessment;
- Reasoning Assessment;
- Evidence Assessment;
- Knowledge Relationship Assessment;
- Identity and Terminology Assessment;
- Curriculum Assessment;
- Safety and Risk Assessment;
- Readiness Assessment;
- Publication Assessment;
- Maintenance Assessment;
- Retirement Assessment.

8.3 Assessment Scope

Every assessment should identify:

- dimension evaluated;
- applicable standard;
- artifact or portfolio scope;
- evidence and context considered;
- conclusion;
- confidence or uncertainty where useful;
- blockers and warnings;
- recommendation;
- assessor identity.

8.4 Assessment Conclusion

An assessment conclusion may be expressed as:

- satisfactory;
- satisfactory with warning;
- deficient;
- indeterminate;
- not applicable;
- additional expertise required;
- additional evidence required.

Assessment vocabulary should preserve meaning rather than imitate a universal score.

8.5 Assessment Explainability

Every assessment should answer:

- What was evaluated?
- Which standard applied?
- What evidence influenced the conclusion?
- Which findings were material?
- What remains uncertain?
- What action is recommended?

8.6 Assessment Scores

Scores may assist prioritisation or structured review.

A score must not conceal the underlying findings.

A high score must not automatically confer approval.

A low score should identify the deficiencies producing the result.

9. Clinical Assessment Standard

A Clinical Assessment evaluates whether the artifact is clinically defensible within its intended scope.

It may consider:

- factual correctness;
- presentation plausibility;
- chronology;
- diagnostic interpretation;
- investigation meaning;
- management safety;
- severity and escalation;
- population applicability;
- contraindications;
- important exceptions;
- risk of harmful misunderstanding.

The assessment should identify whether concerns are:

- inaccurate;
- incomplete;
- misleading;
- unsafe;
- excessively certain;
- context dependent;
- outside reviewer competence.

High-risk clinical claims should receive proportionately detailed rationale.

10. Educational Assessment Standard

An Educational Assessment evaluates whether the artifact fulfils its intended learning purpose.

It may consider:

- alignment with Learning Goals;
- teaching-rule compliance;
- diagnostic reasoning quality;
- clue progression;
- differential discrimination;
- learner level;
- cognitive load;
- misconception prevention;
- educational usefulness;
- curriculum contribution;
- unnecessary duplication.

A clinically correct artifact may fail educational assessment where it is generic, confusing, poorly sequenced, or misaligned with its intended learner outcome.

11. Evidence Assessment Standard

An Evidence Assessment evaluates whether available sources appropriately support the relevant clinical or educational claim.

It should consider:

- source identity;
- source type;
- authority;
- recency;
- population;
- jurisdiction;
- methodological limitations;
- claim alignment;
- conflicting evidence;
- strength of support;
- expiry or review requirement.

The assessment should distinguish:

- source exists;
- source is credible;
- source is applicable;
- source supports the exact claim;
- editorial interpretation is appropriate.

12. Knowledge Relationship Assessment Standard

A Knowledge Relationship Assessment evaluates whether a proposed or active relationship is clinically meaningful, correctly scoped, educationally useful, and sufficiently supported.

It may assess:

- source diagnosis;
- target diagnosis or evidence concept;
- directionality;
- relationship type;
- clinical qualifiers;
- discriminator value;
- risk of overgeneralisation;
- duplication;
- contradiction;
- provenance;
- generalisability beyond the source artifact.

A relationship should not be approved solely because two concepts appear together in text.

13. Curriculum Assessment Standard

A Curriculum Assessment evaluates collections of governed knowledge rather than one artifact.

It may consider:

- diagnosis coverage;
- Learning Goal coverage;
- specialty balance;
- difficulty distribution;
- case diversity;
- population representation;
- repeated teaching;
- missing mimics;
- longitudinal progression;
- maintenance risk.

Curriculum assessments should preserve the portfolio scope and time at which the conclusion was reached.

14. Readiness Assessment

14.1 Purpose

A Readiness Assessment determines whether an artifact or diagnosis satisfies the requirements for a defined next operation.

14.2 Readiness Types

Examples include:

- Generation Readiness;
- Editorial Review Readiness;
- Controlled Application Readiness;
- Playability Readiness;
- Publication Readiness;
- Maintenance Readiness;
- Withdrawal Readiness;
- Retirement Readiness.

14.3 Required Elements

Every Readiness Assessment should preserve:

- operation assessed;

- applicable policy;
- satisfied dependencies;
- blockers;
- warnings;
- missing information;
- resulting conclusion;
- assessment time;
- recommended next action.

14.4 Readiness Outcomes

Canonical outcomes include:

- ready;
- ready with non-blocking warnings;
- not ready;
- indeterminate;
- assessment not applicable.

Readiness must never be represented without explanation.

15. Editorial Review

15.1 Purpose

An Editorial Review is the governed process through which an artifact or editorial question receives the assessments required for an explicit decision.

15.2 Review Identity

Every review should possess a stable identity separate from the artifact it evaluates.

This allows reviews to be reopened, reassigned, compared, and historically preserved.

15.3 Review Scope

A review should identify:

- artifact and version;
- review type;
- governance question;
- required assessment dimensions;
- assigned reviewer or panel;
- applicable standards;
- review status;
- required decision authority.

15.4 Review Packet

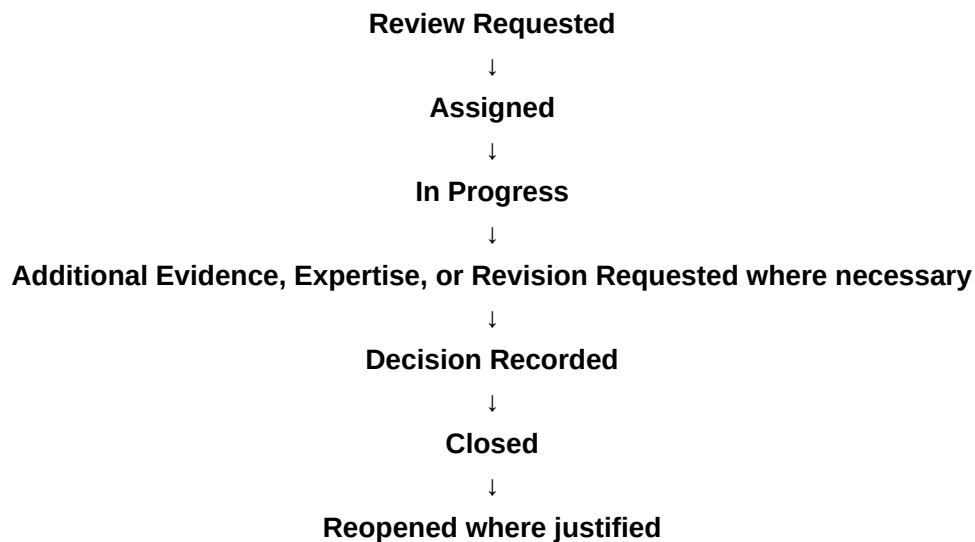
The review should provide sufficient context for safe judgement.

A Review Packet may include:

- current artifact;
- previous version;
- revision comparison;
- diagnosis context;
- Learning Goals;
- Teaching Rules;
- relevant Reasoning Paths;
- evidence;
- validation results;
- previous review findings;
- AI provenance;
- dependency status;
- learner-impact information.

15.5 Review Lifecycle

The canonical review lifecycle is:



15.6 Review Status

Review status describes the progress of the review process.

It must remain separate from the lifecycle status of the artifact being reviewed.

15.7 Review Findings

Findings should be specific, actionable, and linked to the affected content or requirement.

A finding should avoid vague conclusions such as “improve quality” without identifying what is deficient and why it matters.

15.8 Review Completion

A review is complete when:

- required assessments are present;
 - material findings are recorded;
 - required authority has made a decision or explicitly deferred it;
 - resulting obligations are assigned;
 - the review outcome is preserved.
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16. Multi-Reviewer and Panel Review

Some artifacts require more than one reviewer or more than one form of authority.

A multi-reviewer record should preserve:

- each reviewer;
- role and scope;
- individual findings;
- areas of agreement;
- areas of disagreement;
- consolidated conclusion;
- final decision authority.

The final record must not hide clinically material disagreement merely because a majority conclusion was reached.

Where policy requires dual review, two approvals should remain individually attributable.

17. Editorial Decision

17.1 Purpose

An Editorial Decision is an explicit, accountable outcome that changes, confirms, or limits the governed standing of an artifact or editorial question.

17.2 Canonical Decision Types

Canonical decision types include:

- Approve;
- Reject;
- Request Revision;
- Request Evidence;
- Request Specialty Review;
- Accept Candidate;
- Accept AI Draft;
- Decline Candidate;
- Merge;
- Resolve Mapping;

- Defer;
- Escalate;
- Apply;
- Activate;
- Publish;
- Schedule;
- Restrict;
- Withdraw;
- Supersede;
- Deprecate;
- Archive;
- Retire;
- Restore;
- Grant Exception;
- Deny Exception.

Artifact-specific vocabulary may be retained where it expresses a distinct editorial meaning.

17.3 Decision Preconditions

A decision should identify the conditions that permitted the authority to act.

Examples include:

- required validation completed;
- appropriate reviewer assigned;
- evidence available;
- conflict declared and managed;
- dependencies resolved;
- current version confirmed;
- required dual review completed.

17.4 Decision Rationale

The rationale should explain why the selected outcome is preferable to the available alternatives.

Rationale should be proportionate to risk and consequence.

17.5 Decision Effect

The record must specify the transition, permission, or restriction created by the decision.

A decision should not rely on an implementation to infer its meaning from the label alone.

17.6 Conditional Decisions

A decision may be conditional where policy permits.

Conditions should be explicit, measurable, assigned, and time-limited where appropriate.

A conditional approval must not be presented as unrestricted approval.

17.7 Decision Finality

Decisions may be:

- provisional;
- final within ordinary review;
- subject to senior approval;
- subject to publication approval;
- reopened by defined trigger;
- superseded by later decision.

Finality should be explicit.

18. Request Revision Decision

A Request Revision Decision should identify:

- deficient requirement;
- affected location or artifact component;
- clinical or educational consequence;
- required change;
- whether regeneration is permitted;
- whether evidence is required;
- whether the artifact remains eligible for other work;
- required re-review.

Revision requests should be actionable rather than punitive.

19. Rejection Decision

Rejection indicates that candidate or draft knowledge has not been accepted into governed knowledge.

The record should identify:

- reason for rejection;
- whether the defect is remediable;
- whether a new proposal may be created;
- whether the artifact should be retained, archived, or merged;
- affected dependencies;
- whether a source issue remains unresolved.

Rejection should not erase provenance or review history.

20. Approval Decision

Approval indicates that an identifiable artifact version has satisfied its required editorial review.

Approval should preserve:

- approved artifact version;
- required assessments;
- decision-maker and authority;
- conditions or limitations;
- unresolved non-blocking warnings;
- effective time;
- required future review where relevant.

Approval does not automatically imply:

- publication;
 - playability;
 - generation permission;
 - activation;
 - scheduling;
 - evidence permanence.
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21. Validation Result

21.1 Purpose

A Validation Result records the outcome of applying one or more defined validation rules to an artifact version or proposed action.

21.2 Validation Sources

Validation may be:

- deterministic;
- schema-based;
- policy-based;
- referential-integrity based;
- rule-assisted;
- AI-assisted;
- manually confirmed.

The validation source should remain visible.

21.3 Validation Record

A Validation Result should preserve:

- validation run identity;
- artifact and version;

- rule set and version;
- rules evaluated;
- pass, fail, warning, or not-applicable result;
- affected fields or relationships;
- severity;
- remediation guidance;
- time;
- validator identity or system version.

21.4 Severity

Canonical severities may include:

- informational;
- warning;
- blocking;
- critical.

Severity should reflect the transition or operation affected.

21.5 Validation Staleness

A Validation Result may become stale when:

- the artifact changes;
- the rule set changes;
- a dependency changes;
- diagnosis identity changes;
- evidence changes;
- applicable policy changes.

Stale validation must not be treated as current proof of compliance.

21.6 Manual Override

Where policy permits override of a validation result, the override must produce a Governance Exception or explicit decision record.

22. Publication Assessment

A Publication Assessment interprets whether an approved artifact and its dependencies are suitable for learner-facing or institutional release.

It should consider:

- approved version;
- clinical safety;
- educational suitability;
- evidence sufficiency;
- operational readiness;

- diagnosis-level dependencies;
- unresolved warnings;
- publication channel;
- target audience;
- maintenance ownership;
- rollback or withdrawal capability.

Publication Assessment supports but does not replace the Publication Decision.

23. Publication Decision

23.1 Purpose

A Publication Decision authorises or declines learner-facing or institutional exposure of an approved artifact version.

23.2 Required Elements

Every Publication Decision should preserve:

- artifact and approved version;
- publication authority;
- Publication Assessment;
- target channel or track;
- intended audience;
- effective or scheduled time;
- unresolved warnings;
- restrictions;
- maintenance owner;
- withdrawal or supersession relationship where applicable.

23.3 Outcomes

Canonical outcomes include:

- publish now;
- schedule publication;
- publish with restriction;
- defer publication;
- deny publication;
- withdraw;
- supersede.

23.4 Technical Release

Technical deployment or scheduling should produce an operational event linked to the Publication Decision.

Technical release must not create publication authority where no decision exists.

24. Controlled Application Record

24.1 Purpose

A Controlled Application Record preserves the governed transformation through which an accepted proposal is applied to a target artifact.

This is particularly important for AI Drafts, generated repairs, imported changes, and structured editorial migrations.

24.2 Required Elements

The record should preserve:

- accepted proposal or source artifact;
- target artifact and pre-application version;
- authorised action;
- applying actor;
- application time;
- resulting artifact version;
- exact changes;
- conflicts or partial application;
- resulting validation status;
- required re-review.

24.3 Acceptance and Application

Accepting a proposal approves the proposal for use.

Application creates or modifies the governed artifact.

The two actions must remain distinguishable.

24.4 Application Failure

A failed or partial application should preserve:

- attempted change;
- failure type;
- unchanged or partially changed target state;
- rollback outcome;
- required remediation.

No target artifact should remain in an ambiguous state after failed application.

25. AI Governance Records

Every material AI contribution should be traceable through linked records that may include:

- AI Draft Audit;
- automated validation result;
- human review;
- acceptance, rejection, or revision decision;
- Controlled Application Record;
- resulting artifact review;
- Publication Decision.

AI provenance should identify:

- purpose;
- generation context;
- source artifacts and versions;
- model or generator version where available;
- output;
- validation;
- reviewer decision;
- application status.

A high AI trust score, passed schema, or generated state must not be represented as human approval.

26. Withdrawal Record

A Withdrawal Record preserves the decision to remove published knowledge from active learner or institutional exposure.

It should identify:

- artifact and published version;
- reason;
- clinical or educational risk;
- urgency;
- authority;
- effective time;
- affected publication channels;
- replacement where available;
- learner notification requirement;
- downstream dependencies;
- restoration conditions;
- follow-up review.

Withdrawal should not erase publication history.

27. Supersession Record

A Supersession Record identifies that a governed artifact or version has been replaced by a preferred successor.

It should preserve:

- superseded artifact or version;
- successor;
- rationale;
- decision authority;
- effective time;
- treatment of existing dependencies;
- whether historical use remains valid;
- maintenance responsibility.

Supersession differs from deletion and withdrawal.

28. Retirement and Deprecation Records

A Retirement or Deprecation Record should identify:

- artifact or diagnosis;
- reason;
- continued permitted uses;
- prohibited new uses;
- replacement where applicable;
- affected mappings and dependencies;
- historical preservation;
- authority;
- effective time.

Deprecated knowledge may remain accessible for history or mapping while no longer being preferred.

29. Governance Exception

29.1 Purpose

A Governance Exception records a deliberate, authorised, limited departure from an ordinary governance requirement.

29.2 Required Elements

An exception should preserve:

- requirement affected;

- reason;
- scope;
- risk;
- approving authority;
- duration;
- compensating controls;
- prohibited extensions;
- review or expiry condition;
- resulting decision.

29.3 Exception Limits

An exception must not silently alter the underlying standard.

Repeated exceptions should trigger policy review.

A technical override without a Governance Exception is not legitimate editorial governance.

30. Emergency Correction Record

Emergency action may be required where learner-facing knowledge creates a credible and significant risk.

The record should preserve:

- identified risk;
- affected artifact and version;
- emergency action;
- authority;
- time;
- immediate containment;
- learner-facing consequence;
- temporary nature where applicable;
- retrospective review requirement;
- permanent corrective action.

Emergency action may shorten the ordinary pathway.

It must not remove accountability.

31. Disagreement Record

A Disagreement Record preserves material differences between reviewers or authorities.

It should identify:

- issue;

- positions;
- evidence and standards cited;
- clinical consequences;
- educational consequences;
- areas of agreement;
- unresolved questions;
- escalation status.

Disagreement should not be reduced to anonymous comments where it affects institutional trust.

32. Adjudication Record

An Adjudication Record preserves the governed resolution of an escalated disagreement.

It should identify:

- disputed question;
- preceding reviews;
- adjudicator and authority;
- independence or conflict management;
- evidence considered;
- final decision;
- rationale;
- minority or alternative position where material;
- conditions;
- future review trigger.

Adjudication resolves the institutional question without erasing the history of disagreement.

33. Conflict-of-Interest Declaration

Where governance policy requires disclosure, the record should preserve:

- declarant;
- relationship or interest;
- affected artifact or decision;
- date;
- assessed significance;
- management action;
- permitted participation;
- excluded authority;
- reviewing authority.

A declaration should be linked to the affected review or decision.

34. Governance History

34.1 Purpose

Governance History is the ordered, interpretable record of how an artifact or diagnosis evolved through governance.

It is not merely an unordered list of events.

34.2 History Contents

Governance History may include:

- creation and provenance;
- revisions;
- validation runs;
- assessments;
- reviews;
- decisions;
- applications;
- publication;
- maintenance;
- disagreement;
- exceptions;
- withdrawal;
- supersession;
- retirement;
- restoration.

34.3 Historical Reconstruction

The history should make it possible to determine:

- what content existed at any governed point;
- which version was approved;
- which version was published;
- which decision was effective at a given time;
- why the current state exists;
- which obligations remain.

34.4 History Views

Implementations may provide summary and detailed history views.

Summary must not replace the underlying records.

35. Record Linkage and Dependency Impact

Governance Records should preserve relationships to affected dependencies.

A decision may affect:

- diagnosis readiness;
- cases;
- Diagnosis Education;
- Teaching Relationships;
- Reasoning Paths;
- generation context;
- publication eligibility;
- scheduled releases;
- learner-facing content;
- maintenance tasks.

Where a change invalidates downstream confidence, the record should identify which artifacts require reassessment.

36. Reopening Governance

A closed review or decision may require reopening when:

- new evidence emerges;
- an artifact version was misidentified;
- a conflict of interest is discovered;
- a material dependency changes;
- learner feedback reveals ambiguity;
- an implementation defect affected the reviewed content;
- the decision was based on inaccurate information;
- policy requires periodic revalidation.

Reopening should create a new governance episode linked to the earlier record.

The earlier decision should not be silently edited away.

37. Record Amendment and Correction

Governance Records may contain clerical or factual recording errors.

Corrections should preserve:

- original record;
- corrected field or statement;
- correcting actor;

- reason;
- correction time;
- whether the substantive decision changed.

Where the decision itself was wrong, a new decision should supersede it rather than merely editing the old record.

38. Immutability, Deletion, and Retention

Material governance records should be immutable in meaning after finalisation.

Implementations may permit append-only clarification or correction while preserving original content.

Deletion should be exceptional.

Records should normally be retained where they support:

- institutional accountability;
- learner-exposure history;
- audit;
- clinical safety;
- supersession;
- dispute resolution;
- accreditation;
- model and workflow evaluation.

Where legal or privacy requirements require removal, the system should preserve the lawful minimum necessary governance trace where permitted.

39. Access and Confidentiality

Governance transparency does not require unrestricted access to every record.

Access may be limited because of:

- reviewer privacy;
- confidential institutional discussion;
- security;
- legal restrictions;
- sensitive operational information.

Access controls must not permit hidden alteration of the governance record.

Learner-facing systems may expose a simplified provenance or review statement while internal systems preserve the complete record.

40. Governance Record Quality

A high-quality Governance Record should be:

Version-specific. It clearly identifies the artifact state considered.

Purpose-specific. It answers a defined editorial question.

Attributable. The responsible actor and authority are identifiable.

Evidence-informed. Relevant support and limitations are visible.

Explainable. Findings and rationale make the outcome understandable.

Actionable. Required follow-up is explicit.

Linked. Related artifacts, decisions, and resulting changes are traceable.

Durable. History remains recoverable after people and systems change.

Proportionate. Detail reflects clinical and educational consequence.

Non-destructive. Corrections and supersession preserve prior governance.

41. Governance Record Validation

Governance Records themselves should be validated.

Possible record validations include:

- missing artifact version;
- missing decision-maker;
- role lacks required authority;
- missing rationale;
- decision lacks required assessment;
- publication decision lacks approved version;
- application lacks accepted source proposal;
- withdrawal lacks affected publication context;
- exception lacks expiry or compensating control;
- unresolved conflict of interest;
- invalid lifecycle transition.

A technically valid record may still be editorially insufficient.

42. Governance Analytics

Governance Records may support institutional quality analysis.

Examples include:

- decision turnaround time;
- revision frequency;
- disagreement rate;
- post-publication correction rate;
- percentage of decisions with complete rationale;
- validation override rate;
- emergency withdrawal rate;
- AI draft acceptance and modification rate;
- overdue revalidation;
- authority and separation-of-duty compliance.

Analytics should improve governance without reducing decisions to performance targets that encourage unsafe approval speed.

43. Relationship to Implementation

Implementations may represent Governance Records through separate entities, event streams, review objects, decision records, or linked histories.

The implementation must preserve the canonical distinctions and information defined in this Part.

Implementation convenience must not erase:

- version specificity;
- authority;
- rationale;
- decision effect;
- historical linkage;
- separation between validation, assessment, review, decision, application, and publication.

Where current implementation lacks a canonical record, the divergence should be documented and assigned for evolution.

44. Normative Statements

Every material governance action **MUST** produce an identifiable governance record.

Every approval **MUST** apply to an identifiable artifact version.

Every Editorial Decision **MUST** preserve responsible authority and rationale.

Every Publication Decision **MUST** identify an approved artifact version.

Publication **MUST NOT** be inferred from technical release, scheduling, or status mutation alone.

Validation **MUST NOT** be represented as human editorial approval.

Readiness MUST identify the operation assessed and explain blockers and warnings.

Material AI contribution MUST preserve provenance, review, decision, and application status.

Acceptance of an AI Draft MUST remain distinct from controlled application.

Controlled application MUST identify the target pre-application version and resulting version.

Rejected, superseded, withdrawn, and retired artifacts SHOULD remain historically traceable.

Governance exceptions MUST identify the modified requirement, authority, scope, risk, and expiry or review condition.

Emergency action MUST receive retrospective review.

Material reviewer disagreement MUST remain visible through resolution.

A governance record MUST NOT be silently altered in a manner that changes its historical meaning.

Corrections MUST preserve the original record and correcting authority.

Governance History MUST make it possible to reconstruct what was approved and what was exposed to learners.

Technical access MUST NOT be treated as editorial authority.

Governance Record validation SHOULD detect missing authority, version context, rationale, required assessments, and invalid transitions.

45. Relationship to the Wider Canon

Part I establishes the universal artifact and governance principles.

Part II defines the diagnosis foundation to which governance records attach.

Part III defines the review, validation, approval, playability, and publication requirements of Clinical Cases.

Part IV defines the governance requirements of Diagnosis Education.

Part V defines the governance of knowledge relationships, evidence, and reasoning artifacts.

Part VI defines the candidate, review, acceptance, application, and publication controls applicable to AI Drafts.

This Part defines the records through which all of those decisions become explicit, auditable, and institutionally durable.

Closing Principle

Governed knowledge is not defined only by what the current artifact says.

It is defined by the transparent history through which people evaluated it, exercised authority, accepted responsibility, and authorised its use.

Within WEOS:

Assessments interpret knowledge.

Reviews organise judgement.

Decisions establish governed outcomes.

Publication expresses institutional trust.

Governance Records preserve why that trust was justified.